THE LEARNING LOOP

Democracy Matters

Today's Special Topic: Bypassing instead of denial



Civics & Basic Concepts

☆☆☆

TODAY +★



Communication & Social Media

☆☆☆



Action & Mobilisation

☆☆☆

☆☆☆ are the slots per pillar. Everyone collects their own — My DM shows where you stand.

1 · Special Topic 30′

Bypassing — the sprint

2 · The round

Discussion & wind-down

The Learning Loop — Learn it. Keep it. · 3★ per pillar → DM Champion · 6★ → DM Master

SPECIAL TOPIC

Bypassing instead of denial

How to answer misinformation without just contradicting it

Warm-up	Video	Topic	Discussion	Take-away
5′	5′	7′	5′	5′

Why this topic? Before every vote, claims circulate that aren't true. A "that's not true" helps less than you'd think. There is a second way — and a clear line where it becomes unfair.

Sprint
30m

1 — WARM-UP

Phones out



Scan the QR, enter a name — three questions, everyone at once.

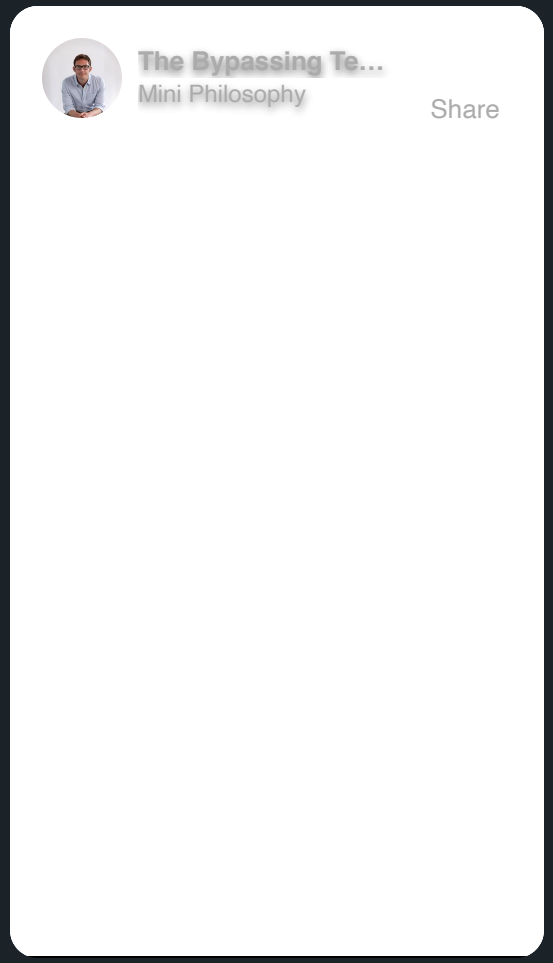
tigerraph.github.io/dm-quiz
Join — if the QR code acts up

Open the beamer view →
Host: starts the game and shows questions, answers, leaderboard

Time
5m

After each question: answer + explanation — the app does that.

2 — VIDEO



What is bypassing?

Mini Philosophy explains the technique in 90 seconds — in English, with subtitles.

Video not playing? Scan the QR or open the link:
facebook.com/reel/1160919765939031

Time
5m

Video: Mini Philosophy, “The Bypassing Technique” (Facebook, 1:29)

2 — VIDEO · THE SHORT VERSION

Bypassing in four sentences

What	Don’t contradict — add something true.
How	True fact, same object, opposite direction.
When	Short claims, before minds are made up.
Line	True facts only, said openly — no manipulation.

The video says “don’t fact-check” — the study doesn’t: a detailed fact-check stays strong.

2 — TOPIC · LIVE EXPERIMENT

An experiment with you

BOTH SLIPS ANSWER THIS FALSE HEADLINE

“Tap water is unhealthy.”

1. The moderator hands out slips: **left** side of the room gets slip **A**, **right** side slip **B**.
2. Read your slip silently. **Don’t show it.**
3. Show with **1–5 fingers**: would you drink tap water instead of bottled?

→ Next slide: we compare the two sides.

Slips to print

Time
7m

The paper tested with a made-up product. The tap-water example is ours.

2 — TOPIC · THE CHECK

Two answers to the same false claim

HEADLINE

"Tap water is unhealthy."

A · CONTRADICTS IT (DENIAL)

"Tap water is **not** unhealthy."

B · LEAVES IT, ADDS A TRUE FACT (BYPASSING)

"Tap water costs a fraction of bottled water and needs no plastic bottle."

Bypassing leaves the false claim standing and puts something **true** on the other side of the scale: same object, opposite direction.

In experiments, after short headlines, it worked **slightly** better than a short denial. A small edge, found repeatedly.

No edge if people already made up their minds while reading. A detailed fact-check stays strong.

Granados Samayoa & Albarracín, University of Pennsylvania · Journal of Experimental Psychology: General, 2025

2 — TOPIC · WHERE THE LINE IS

Fair or dodging?

EXAMPLE · A REAL CONCERN

“The wolf kills our sheep.”

That is no rumour. Answering with some other upside would be dodging. Acknowledge first, then talk.

EXAMPLE · A TRUE CORE

“Initiatives only make it with forged signatures.”

If there are individual real cases, acknowledge them first. Then correct the generalisation. Pure bypassing looks like whitewashing.

Bypassing adds a **true** claim to a **false** one. Spin makes a legitimate concern disappear.

3 — OPEN DISCUSSION

What do you think?

💬 Where have you seen a denial backfire?

💬 When would bypassing feel manipulative?

💬 Would you use it — and where not?

2:00 ▶ Start timer

Time
5m

4 — TAKE-AWAY · BOTTOM LINE ★

“Contradicting misinformation? It’s pointless anyway.”

★ Claim your star now

Moderator: award the star →

Your kit for exactly that conversation:

🔍 **Check first**

Is it really false? If it has a true core, acknowledge that first.

⚖️ **A true counterweight**

Same object, opposite direction, at least as strong — and it has to be true.

🗣️ **Say it openly**

“Do you know this side too?” If that would embarrass you, it’s manipulation.



Otherwise correct

If nothing true speaks against it: explain in detail, not just “not true”.

Time

5m

Bottom line → Master Checklist · Communication star ★ earned

The round

DEMOCRACY MATTERS

Merci!

The Learning Loop — design & concept of the gamified workshop format

Slides, quiz & star — everything to revisit

tigerraph.github.io/dm-quiz/content/bypassing.html

FOR THE MODERATOR

Run sheet

Run sheet on your phone

before	**Print** and cut the slips (A left, B right). No slips: read A to the left half while the right half closes their eyes — then the reverse with B.
15:00 (5′)	**Warm-up** — QR slide, **open the beamer view**, play the 3 questions. The app shows the explanations.
15:05 (5′)	**Video** — reel from the slide (1:29, English). Blocked? QR or link. Then the four-sentence short version.
15:10 (7′)	**Topic** — live experiment (slips, read silently, 1–5 fingers), check slide, then “where the line is” as information.
15:17 (5′)	**Discussion** — open round, no group task. The three questions on the slide are prompts; you don’t need all of them.
15:22 (5′)	**Take-away** — kit, bottom line onto the Master Checklist, Communication star ★. Never cut. Then buffer, the round.

Details: docs/runbook-bypassing.md · To revisit: …/content/bypassing.html